Mercenary

Game Summary

Mercenary is a 2-4 digital area control board game with strong lean into card strategy set in medieval British Isles, where players choose one of 4 factions and conquer the most amount of territory by fighting for it.

Mercenary is based on a board game “Condottieri” with several revisions and changes in core game rules.

Technical Summary

Game Engine: GoDot

Player Count: 2-4

Genre: Area Control / Card Strategy

Estimated Play Time: 30-60 minutes per game

Version Control: Git/GitHub

Game Process

Game Objective (Win Conditions):

Players compete against each other to conquer regions of the British Isles by fighting between each other using their armies (cards). A player wins by achieving either of the two conditions:

- First to control 5 total regions
- First to control 3 adjacent regions

    Regions are adjacent to each other if they share a common border on the map.

Game Objects:

Conquer Token - used to choose a location that the fight is going to take place for by choosing one of sixteen locations.
Faction Token - each conquered location gets a faction token of the faction that took control of the location.
Favor of the Pope -

Phase:

Kick Off Phase

1. Player chooses one of 4 factions.
2. One of 4 players randomly gets chosen to play first
    - Each player then gets 10 random cards from the deck/

3. Player places a Conquer Token on a desired location.
    a. The player who placed the Conquer Token token starts the round first by placing it on any uncontrolled region.

Battle Phase

1. Place one card face up on the battlefield.

    ~A player's total strength is the sum of the strength values of all of the cards in his battle line, taking into account any modifications caused by special cards

    ~Note that players are never required to play a card in a battle. That is, a player can choose to pass on any of his turns.

    ~Pass: if the player passes the turn he is officially excluding himself from further card addition simply waiting for the end of battle.

2. Concluding a Battle ,Players continue taking turns, choosing to either play a card or pass, until either all the players have passed or one player plays a "Surrender" card. Then the battle is concluded.

Comparison Phase

1. All players announce the total strength of their battle lines. The player with the strongest battle line conquers the region. He then places one of his control markers on the conquered region and receives the Conquer token.

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Factions

Each faction holds a special passive ability than can be used every Battle Phase

Scotland

Highland Morale:

Scotland holds an to add +2 to all mercenaries on Counting Phase

Ireland

Spy Work:

Ireland holds an ability to exchange any card from the opponent's battlefield for one of his cards.

Whales

Storm Control:

Whales holds an ability to discard all weather abilities applied on the battlefield

England

Bluff:

England holds an ability to place all of the used cards face down on the battlefield up until counting phase

Cards

Main Cards

Mercenary - Mercenary cards are the most common type of strength-providing

Season Cards:

Winter:

When a Winter card is in play when a battle is concluded, all Mercenary cards are considered to have a printed strength of 1.

~When a Winter card is played, immediately discard all Spring or Autumn cards in play.

Spring:

When a Spring card is in play when a battle is concluded, each player adds 3 strength to each of his Mercenary cards that is among the highest strength Mercenaries in play.

~When a Spring card is played, immediately discard all Winter or Autumn cards in plays.

Autumn:

When an Autumn card is in play none of the players can use scarecrow or surrender cards.

~When an Autumn card is played, immediately discard all Winter or Spring cards in plays.

Special Cards:

Bishop:

When a Bishop card is played, all of the highest-strength Mercenary card(s) in play are discarded.

The player who played the Bishop card then receives the Favor of the Pope token, and must immediately decide whether to place it on a region that does not contain a control marker or leave the token off the game board. The Condottiere token may not be placed on any region that has the favor of the Pope. The Favor of the Pope token represents the Church intervening on the region's behalf and ensuring that no battles are fought there.

Courtesan:

If, during the "Compare Strength" step, a player's battle line contains the most Courtesan cards, that player receives the Condottiere token instead of the player that actually won the battle.

The player who won the battle places his control marker on the contested region, but the player with the most Courtesan chooses where the next battle will be fought, and takes the first turn in the next battle.

Drummer:

When a battle is concluded, Mercenary cards in the same battle line as a Drummer card have their printed strength doubled.

Heroine:

Heroine has a strength of 10,but is not considered a Mercenary card (and is therefore not affected by Winter, Spring, Drummer, or Scarecrow cards)

Scarecrow:

Playing a Scarecrow card allows a player to retrieve one of his own Mercenary cards from his battle line back into his hand

Surrender:

When a player plays this card, he immediately brings the battle to an end, and the region is captured by the player who has the strongest battle line at the moment the Surrender card is played.

Hierarchy of Abilities:

Some of the abilities can

Surrender	
Bishop	
Scarecrow	
Drummer	
Winter/Spring	
Faction Abilities	
Courtesan	

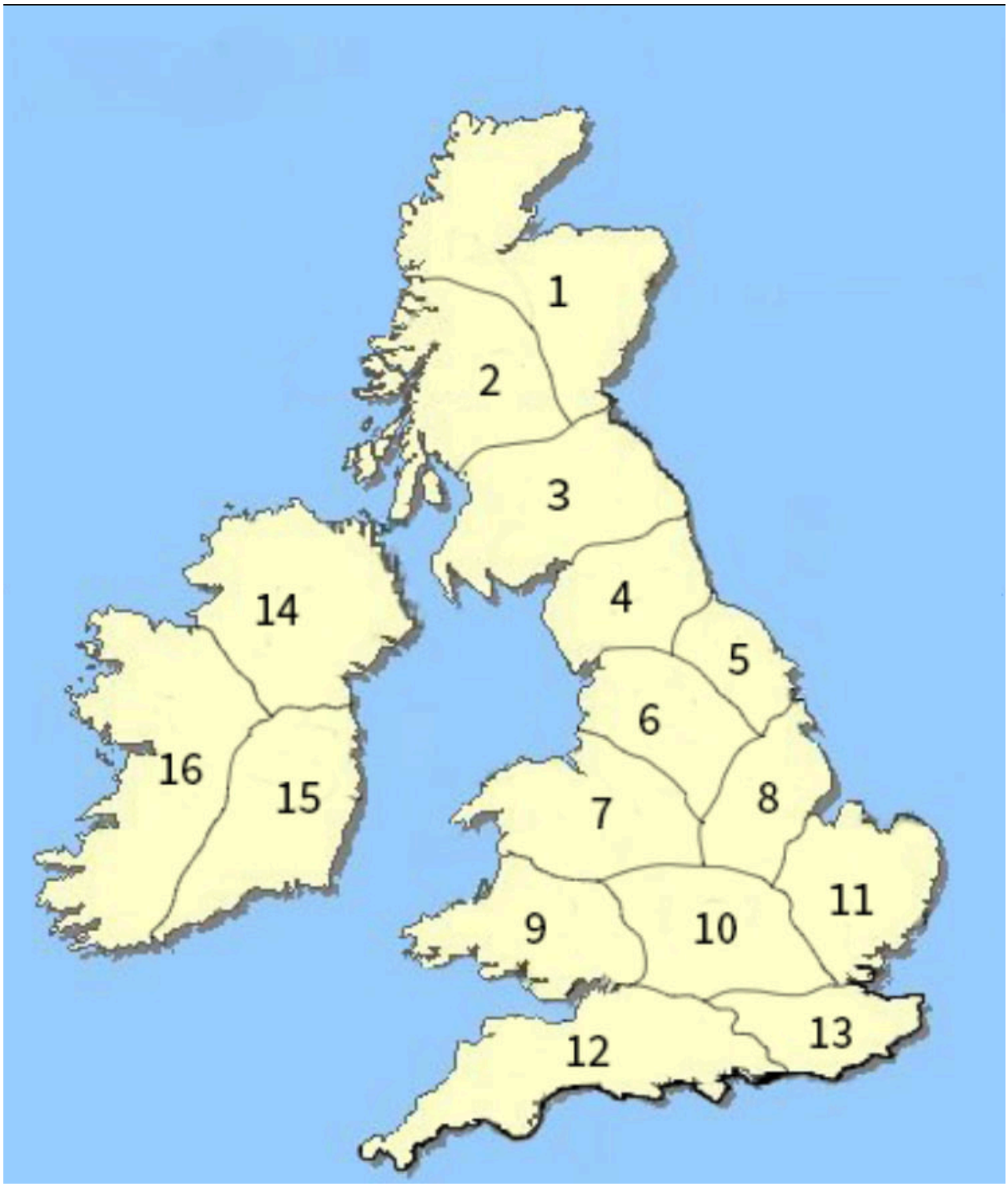
Card Distribution:

Card Name (Value of Strength)	Amount of Cards in the deck (out of 110)
Mercenary (1)	10
Mercenary (2)	8
Mercenary (3)	8
Mercenary (4)	8
Mercenary (5)	8
Mercenary (6)	8
Mercenary (10)	8
Winter	2
Spring	2
Autumn	2
Bishop	3
Courtesan	12
Drummer	6
Heroine	3
Scarecrow	16
Surrender	3

Hand Management

Map

Map:



Locations:

Region	Territory Name	Adjacent Territory
1	Highland	Lowland,Strathclyde (2)

2	Lowland	Highland,Strathclyde,Dunwall (3)
3	Strathclyde	Lowland,Highland, Northumbria (3)
4	Northumbria	Strathclyde, Ulster, Mercia, East Anglia (4)
5	Connacht	Northumbria, Mercia, Kent (3)
6	Ulster	Northumbria, East Anglia, Wales, Wessex (4)
7	Leinster	Mercia, Wessex (2)
8	Munster	East Anglia, Wessex (2)
9	Mercia	Leinster,East Anglia,Wessex (2)
10	East Anglia	Leinster,Munster,Mercia,Wales,Wessex,Kent (6)
11	Wales	Munster,East Anglia,Kent (3)
12	Wessex	Mercia,East Anglia,Kent (3)
13	Kent	East Anglia,Wales,Wessex (3)
14	Dunwall	Cornwall,Velem,Lowland (3)
15	Cornwall	Dunwall,Velen (2)
16	Velen	Dunwall,Cornwall (2)

Team Roles & Overview

Team Lead./Game Designer - Omar Aslan

- Define and balance game rules, card actions, faction abilities.
- Development and active GDD maintenance

Lead. Programer/Game Designer - Igor

- Implement core game loop and card systems.
- Defines technical architecture for the game.

Programer - Togzhan

- Implements AI logic,map interaction, and UI systems

Narrative Writer/Artist - Konstantine Maslov

- Defines in game narrative, creates all story/description feeds.
- Cards art development

UI/Artist - Ayana Kasenova

- User Interface creation, card art development support.